

HOUSE No. 4883

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, December 29, 2025.

The committee on Children, Families and Persons with Disabilities, to whom were referred the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 198) of James C. Arena-DeRosa for legislation to authorize video cameras to be installed at entrances, exits, and common areas of certain private facilities under the authority of the Department of Developmental Services; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 200) of Brian M. Ashe relative to the rights of deaf children; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 203) of Christine P. Barber and Sally P. Kerans for legislation to establish a protection and advocacy system for investigating abuse, neglect, and financial exploitation of persons with disabilities occurring and advocating for the civil and human rights of such persons; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 204) of Donald R. Berthiaume, Jr., relative to the Department of Children and Families providing official documentation of child counsel appointments; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 205) of Donald R. Berthiaume, Jr., relative to background checks for kinship foster care; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 206) of Donald R. Berthiaume, Jr., relative to providing that certain foster care children have the right to be emancipated from their biological parents; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 211) of Mark J. Cusack for legislation to support the transition to adult services for persons with disabilities; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 212) of Michael S. Day for legislation to promote employment for people with disabilities; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 213) of Marjorie C. Decker relative to ensuring access to behavioral health services for children involved with state agencies; the petition (accompanied by resolve, House, No. 218) of Carol A. Doherty and James K. Hawkins for legislation to establish the harmony commission to study the welfare of children in care and protection cases; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 228) of Tricia Farley-Bouvier and Joanne M. Comerford for legislation to further regulate the Office of the Child Advocate; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 229) of

Tricia Farley-Bouvier relative to making foster parents public employees and providing them with certain collective bargaining rights; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 230) of Tricia Farley-Bouvier relative to the powers of the Child Advocate to appear, intervene in or bring actions on behalf the Commonwealth; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 238) of Paul K. Frost relative to providing low interest loans to families with children suffering from terminal illnesses; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 239) of Paul K. Frost for legislation to establish a special task force (including members of the General Court) to review and report on the economic impact of welfare reform in the Commonwealth; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 248) of Steven S. Howitt relative to at-risk children and their proper placement and establishing a special commission (including members of the General Court) to make an investigation of such placements; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 251) of Bradley H. Jones, Jr., and others that the Office of the State Auditor annually conduct an audit of and report on the Department of Transitional Assistance; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 257) of David Henry Argosky LeBoeuf relative to public accommodations for individuals with verbal communication impairments; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 263) of Marc T. Lombardo relative to eligibility for certain entitlement programs; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 271) of Joan Meschino, David F. DeCoste and Colleen M. Garry relative to the placement of foster children with family members and preventing discrimination against potential foster parents based on irrelevant convictions; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 284) of Margaret R. Scarsdale and Michael D. Brady that the Department of Developmental Services establish caseload ratios for certain human service coordinators; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 286) of Alan Silvia and Steven George Xiarhos relative to autism education reform and to facilitate appropriate interactions with persons on the autism spectrum; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 288) of Chynah Tyler relative to preventing funds deposited in children's savings accounts from counting against cash assistance benefits; the petition (accompanied by resolve, House, No. 292) of David T. Vieira for legislation to establish a special commission (including members of the General Court) to review Department of Developmental Services regulations and practices; the petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 296) of Paul McMurtry relative to financial exploitation of certain adults with disabilities; and the petition (subject to Joint Rule 12) of Colleen M. Garry that the Department of

Developmental Services consider neuropsychological evaluations of certain persons with intellectual disabilities, reports recommending that the accompanying order (House, No. 4883) ought to be adopted.

For the committee,

JAY D. LIVINGSTONE.

HOUSE No. 4883

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts



House of Representatives,

1 *Ordered,* That the committee on Children, Families and Persons with Disabilities be
2 authorized to sit during a recess of the General Court to make an investigation and study of
3 House documents numbered 198, 200, 203, 204, 205, 206, 211, 212, 213, 218, 228, 229, 230,
4 238, 239, 248, 251, 257, 263, 271, 284, 286, 288, 292, 296 and 4180, relative to Study order .

5 Said committee shall report to the General Court the results of its investigation and study
6 and its recommendations, if any, together with drafts of legislation necessary to carry such
7 recommendations into effect, by filing the same with the Clerk of the House of Representatives
8 on or before December 31, 2026.